

URBANIZATION & MIGRATION ESI 2025

Urbanization in India

PYQs asked from this chapter:

Q1. Although urbanization is spreading to villages but race, caste, gender discrimination is rampant in this light. Write about challenges faced by protective discriminatory policy?
(DESCRIPTIVE)

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URBANIZATION

Urbanization is a **form of social transformation from traditional rural societies to modern, industrial, and urban communities**. It is **long term** continuous process. *It is progressive concentration of population in urban unit.*

History

- **Indus Valley civilization** saw the birth as the earliest urban settlement in human history.
In India, the **urban tradition continuous throughout these centuries** and during the **ancient period of our history** there were many well planned, big, and beautiful cities in different parts of the country.

Urbanization: Prospects

- Future growth of world's population is supposed to take place in the urban areas of less developed countries and the contribution of India in terms of urban population size, is quite substantial. **India is one among the country where the process of urbanization is an integral part of the development.**
- According to 2011 census only 31 percent of the population of India lives in urban areas.
- As per National Commission on Population, **India's urban population will increase from 377 million in 2011 to 594 million in 2036 – a growth of 57%.**
- In India, urbanization has been relatively slow during the last century period as compared with many other developing countries.

Definition of Urban Places (Indian Scenario)

In India the definition of urban remained more or less same for the period 1901-1951. **However, in 1961 census, several modifications were made** the definition of town adopted for the 1961 census was much more rigorous and further, this new definition was followed all over the country. **Indian Census definition of urban area in census of India, 2001 two types of towns was identified.**

STATUTORY TOWNS:

The first category of urban units is known as Statutory Towns. **These towns are notified under law by the concerned State/UT Government** and **have local bodies like municipal corporations, municipalities, municipal committees, etc., irrespective of their demographic characteristics** as reckoned on 31st December 2009.

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Examples: Vadodara (M Corp.), Shimla (M Corp.) etc. All places with municipality, corporations, cantonment board or notified town area committee declared by state law.

Further, Statutory Towns with population of 1,00,000 and above are categorized as cities.

Census towns

According to Census of India (2011), places which satisfy following criteria can be defined as census town:

1. **Any place with a Municipality, Corporation or Cantonment area, Notified town area.**
2. **A minimum population of 5000.**
3. **At least 75% of male working population engaged in non -agricultural activities.**
4. **A density of population of at least 400 persons per square kilometer.**

Urban Agglomeration (UA)

- **An urban agglomeration is a continuous urban spread constituting a town and its adjoining outgrowths (OGs), or two or more physically contiguous towns together with or without outgrowths of such towns.**
- **An Urban Agglomeration must consist of at least a statutory town and its total population (i.e. all the constituents put together) should not be less than 20,000 as per the 2001 Census.** In varying local conditions, there were similar other combinations which have been treated as urban agglomerations satisfying the basic condition of contiguity. **Examples: Greater Mumbai UA, Delhi UA, etc.**

Out Growths (OG)

An outgrowth (OG) is a viable unit such as a village or a hamlet or an enumeration block made up of such village or hamlet and clearly identifiable in terms of its boundaries and location.

Some of the examples are **railway colony, university campus, port area, military camps, etc.,** which have come up near a statutory town outside its statutory limits but within the revenue limits of a village or villages contiguous to the town.

While **determining the outgrowth of a town**, it has been ensured that **it possesses the urban features** in terms of infrastructure and amenities such as pucca roads, electricity, taps, drainage system for disposal of wastewater etc. educational institutions, post offices, medical facilities, banks etc. and physically contiguous with the core town of the UA. **Examples: Central Railway Colony (OG), Triveni Nagar**

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(N.E.C.S.W.) (OG), etc. Each such town together with its outgrowth(s) is treated as an integrated urban area and is designated as an 'urban agglomeration'.

In the **2011 Census**, **475 places with 981 OGs** have been identified as **Urban Agglomerations** as against 384 UAs with 962 OGs in 2001 Census.

Number of UAs/Towns and Out Growths (OGs)

Type of Towns/UAs/OGs		Number of towns	
		2001 Census	2011 Census
1	Statutory Towns	3799	4041
2	Census Towns	1362	3894
3	Urban Agglomerations	384	475
4	Out Growths	962	981

Source: Data computed and compiled from 2001 & 2011 Census report

As per the **Census 2011 there are 7,935 towns in the country**. The number of towns has increased by 2,774 since last Census. Many of these towns are part of UAs and the rest are independent towns. The total number of Urban Agglomerations/Towns, which constitutes the urban frame, is 6166 (the combined total of UAs, which are defined as a core town and its contiguous outgrowths, and independent towns) in the country.

Population of UAs/Towns

- ❖ The total urban population in the country as per Census 2011 is more than 377 million constituting **31.16% of the total population**.
- ❖ **Class I UAs/Towns:** The UAs/Towns are grouped on the basis their population in Census. The UAs/Towns which have **at least 1,00,000 persons as population are categorized as Class I UA/Town**. As per the Census 2011, there are 468 such UAs/Towns. The corresponding number in Census 2001 was 394.

264.9 million persons, constituting 70% of the total urban population, live in this **Class I UAs/Towns**. The proportion has increased considerable over the last Census. In the remaining classes of towns, the growth has been nominal.

- ❖ **Million Plus UAs/Towns:** Out of 468 UAs/Towns belonging to Class I category, 53 UAs/Towns each has a **population of one million or above each**. Known as

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Million Plus UAs/Cities, these are the **major urban centers in the country**. **160.7 million Persons (or 42.6% of the urban population) live in these Million Plus UAs/Cities.** 18 new UAs/Towns have been added to this list since the last Census.

- ❖ **Mega Cities:** among the Million plus UAs/Cities, **there are three very large UAs with more than 10 million** persons in the country, known as Mega Cities. **These are Greater Mumbai UA (18.4 million), Delhi UA (16.3 million) and Kolkata UA (14.1 million).**
- ❖ **The largest UA in the country is Greater Mumbai** UA followed by Delhi UA. Kolkata UA which held the second rank in Census 2001 has been replaced by Delhi UA.
- ❖ **The growth in population in the Mega Cities has slowed down considerably during the last decade. Greater Mumbai UA has recorded 12.05% during 2001-2011. Similarly, Delhi UA (from 52.24% to 26.69% in 2001-2011) and Kolkata UA (from 19.60% to 6.87% in 2001-2011) have also slowed down considerably.**

CAUSES OF URBANIZATION IN INDIA:

Urbanization has become a common feature of Indian society. **Growth of Industries has contributed to the growth of cities.** As a result of industrialization people have started moving towards the industrial areas in search of employment. **This has resulted in the growth of towns and cities.** Various reasons have led to the growth of cities:

- **Industrialization:** Industrialization is a **trend representing a shift from the old agricultural economics to novel non-agricultural economy**, which creates a modernized society. **Through industrial revolution, more people have been attracted to move from rural to urban areas on the account of improved employment opportunities.**
- **Commercialization:** Commerce and trade play a major role in urbanization. The **distribution of goods and services and commercial transactions** in the modern era has developed modern marketing institutions and exchange methods that have tremendously given rise to the growth of towns and cities.
- **Social benefits and services:** There are **numerous social benefits attributed to life in the cities and towns.** Examples include **better educational facilities, better living standards, and better sanitation and housing, better health care,**

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better recreation facilities, and better social life in general.

- **Employment opportunities:** In cities and towns, there are **ample job opportunities** that continually draw people from the rural areas to seek better livelihood. Therefore, the **majority of people frequently migrate into urban areas to access well-paying jobs.**
- **Modernization and changes in the mode of living:** Modernization plays a very important role in the process of urbanization. **As urban areas become more technology savvy together with highly sophisticated communication, infrastructure, medical facilities, dressing code, enlightenment, liberalization, and other social amenities availability, people believe they can lead a happy life in cities.**
- **Rural urban transformation:** As **localities become more fruitful and prosperous due to the discovery of minerals, resource exploitation, or agricultural activities, cities start emerging, as the rural areas transform to urbanism.**

SALIENT FEATURES OF INDIAN URBAN CENTERS:

A sociological analysis of urban community contains several salient features. They are as follows:

- **Size:** As a rule, in the same country and at the same period, the **size of an urban community is much larger than that of a rural community.** I
- **Marriage:** In case of urban community **there is a preponderance of love marriages and inter-caste marriages.** One also comes across a greater number of divorces. **Sons and daughters enjoy considerable freedom** in choosing their life partners.
- **Class extremes:** In the words of Bogardus, **"Class extremes characterize the city."** A **town and a city house the richest as well as the poorest of people.**
- **Social heterogeneity:** **If villages are the symbol of cultural homogeneity, the cities symbolize cultural heterogeneity.** The cities are characterized by diverse peoples, races and cultures.
- **Social distance:** Social distance is the result of anonymity and heterogeneity. Most of one's routine social **contacts in a town or city are impersonal and segmentary in character.** In the urban community social responses are incomplete and

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halfhearted.

- **System of interaction:** Georg Simmel held that the **social structure of urban communities is based on interest groups**. *The circles of social contact are wider in the city than in the country. There is a wider area of interaction system per man and per aggregate.*
- **Mobility:** The most important feature of **urban community is its social mobility**. *In urban areas the **social status of an individual is determined not by heredity or birth but by his merit, intelligence and perseverance***. Urbanity and mobility are positively correlated.
- **Materialism:** In the **urban community the social existence of man revolves round wealth and material possessions**.
- **Individualism:** The urbanites attach **supreme importance to their own welfare and happiness**. *They hesitate to think or act for the good of others.*
- **Rationality:** In urban community **there is emphasis on rationality**. *People are inclined to reason and argue.*
- **Anonymity:** As Bogardus observes, the “**Urban groups have a reputation for namelessness**.” By virtue of its size and population, the urban community cannot be a primary group. *Here nobody knows anybody, and nobody cares for anybody.*
- **High Population & Density:** The **urban areas comprise of the cities and the towns**, and they have *the higher density of population* as compared to other areas.
- **Cultural Heterogeneity:** In urban areas, **cultural heterogeneity is commonly found**. *This is due to the fact that individuals migrate to urban areas on a large scale*. The main aspects that lead to migration of the individuals are education, employment opportunities and health care and medical facilities.
- **Non-Agricultural Economy:** The occupations and the employment opportunities of the individuals in urban areas are **based on the non-agricultural sector**. **Individuals are professionals** such as doctors, lawyers, researchers, teachers, educationists and so forth.
- **Higher Social Mobility:** In the urban areas, more social mobility is found amongst the individuals. *Individuals get easily adapted to the class structure, which can be upper, middle, or lower class on the basis of the economic criteria.*

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- **Higher Social Communication:** Communication is considered to be an imperative area for the progress and welfare of the individuals. ***In urban areas, interaction amongst the individuals is based on secondary contact and not primary contact.*** It means, people normally communicate with each other through technology and making use of other technical devices, such as emails, messaging, texts and so forth.
- **Telecommunication Services:** In urban areas, *the role of telecommunications has played an imperative role in the growth and advancement of the economy.* There is **a broad potential for leading to an increase in the telecommunication services within the country.**
- **Technological area:** In urban areas, *the usage of technology in the implementation of all kinds of transactions and operations has largely led to progression of the individuals.* ***In offices, individuals make use of technology to prepare reports, documents and create communication links with the other individuals.***
- **Self-Living:** In urban areas, individuals *normally remain occupied with their own lives.* ***They normally adopt an urban way of life. Formal interaction, impersonal behavioral traits, non-kinship relationships,*** is some of the attributes that the individuals possess.
- **Nuclear Families:** In urban areas, individuals ***mostly reside in nuclear families and family disintegration is considered to be an important feature.*** *Individuals normally move out of their homes to other regions with the main purposes of education or employment opportunities.*
- **Rapid social and cultural change:** Rapid social and cultural change characterizes urban life. ***The importance attached to traditional or sacred elements has been relegated to the background.*** The benefits of urban life have effected changes in respect of norms, ideologies, and behavior patterns.
- **Voluntary associations:** The urban community is characterized by ***impersonal, mechanical, and formal social contacts occurring among the people.*** *Naturally they have a strong desire for developing genuine social relationships to satisfy their hunger for emotional warmth and sense of security.* They form associations, clubs, societies, and other secondary groups.
- **Formal social control:** Social control in urban community is essentially formal in nature. ***Individual's behavior is regulated by such agencies as police, jails,***

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law courts etc.

- **Secularization of outlook:** *In cities ritual and kinship obligations are diluted.* Caste and community considerations yield to economic logic. This results in secularization of outlook.
- **Modernization:** Urban areas **provide impulses for modernization** in society as a whole.

TRENDS OF URBAN PROCESS IN INDIA:

- ❖ **Urbanization is an integral part of economic development**, as the economy develops; there is an **increase in the per capita income** and **also the demand for non- farm goods** in the economy.
- ❖ **These goods are not heavily land dependent** and **use more of the other factors of production especially labor and capital.** They are **cheaper if produced in the urban sector** of the economy since urban settlements enjoy economies of agglomeration in manufacturing services and provision of infrastructure. **Economic growth influences the rate of urbanization**, while urbanization in turn, affects the rate at which the economy grows. *As the country urbanizes, the share of national income that originates in the urban sector also increases.*
- ❖ **Urbanization brings in its wake a number of challenges such as rapid population growth in urban settlements, which is cited as the biggest challenges in most literature on this subject.** This is consequences of births exceeding deaths, migration of rural population to urban centers and also the classification of rural settlements as towns. Apart from growing population, there are other challenges too.
- ❖ The first **set of challenges relates to the inadequate growth of formal employment**, resulting in the growth of the **urban informal sector**, open urban unemployment and under employment. **The second set of challenges arises out of the inability of the urban physical and social infrastructure to grow in tandem with population**, resulting in the deterioration the quality of urban life.

Table: 1 Total population and urban population from 1901 - 2011

Census year	Total population	Urban population	Percentage of urban
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	(million)	(million)	population to total population
1901	238.3	25.8	10.83
1911	252.1	25.9	10.27
1921	251.3	28.1	11.18
1931	278.9	33.5	12.01
1941	318.6	44.2	13.87
1951	361.0	62.4	17.29
1961	439.2	78.9	17.96
1971	548.1	109.1	19.91
1981	683.3	159.4	23.33
1991	846.3	217.6	25.71
2001	1027.1	285.4	27.78
2011	1210.2	377.1	31.16

Source: Data computed and compiled from 1901-2011 Census report

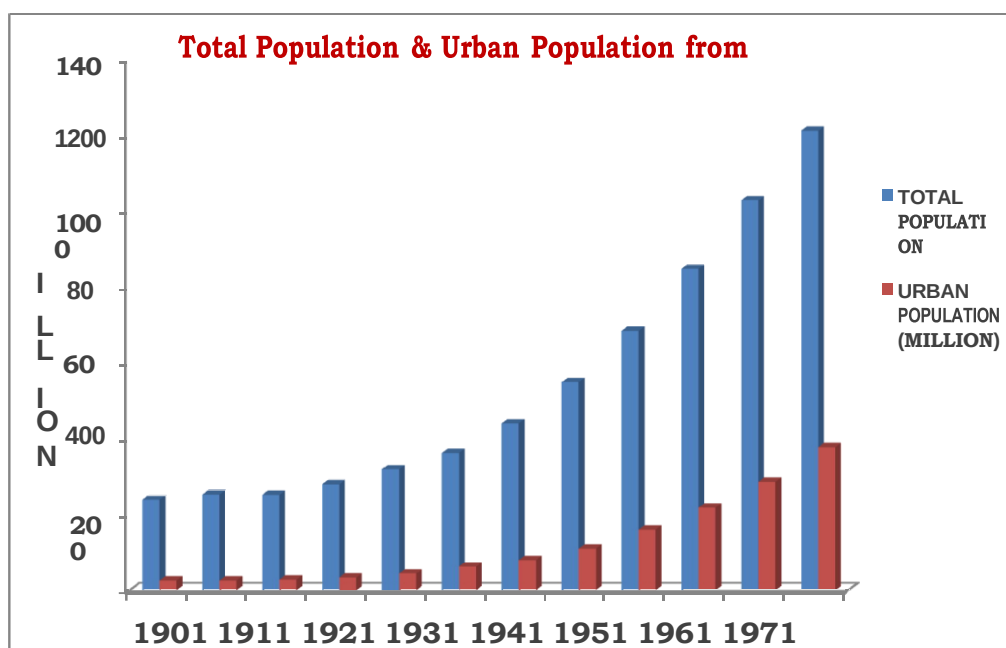


Figure: 1

Total population and urban population from 1901 to 2011

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- ❖ Table 1 shows the **total population and urban population from 1901 to 2011 census years**. The **population has increased from 238.3 million in 1901 to 1210.1 million in 2011**.
- ❖ The **size of the countries urban population is increased from 11 percent in 1901 to 31 percent in 2011**.
- ❖ From this, it has been observed that **there is more than tenfold increase** in the country's urban population and the countries level of urbanization has increased by only about 2.5 times during past 100 years.
- ❖ From table it is observed that **during first half century 1901 to 1951, the growth rate of urbanization has been very slow but after 1951 it starts increasing very sharply**.

When compared to the other means of development, the growth of urban population in our country is almost similar to that of other modern developments, especially after independence.

- ❖ During the **19th century the urban growth has shown increasing trend except on account of accidental decline, especially 1901 -1911 on account of epidemics** like plague and others broke out population in many cities was temporarily evacuated and millions of urbanites died. During later period until 1941 the growth rate of urban population was quite slow.
- ❖ **In between the 1901-1941, the size of urban population increases from 25.9 million to 44.1 million** that is about 18 million of individuals was added in the period of four decades.
- ❖ The **enormous increase** in the **size and the proportion of urban population accounted during the decade 1941-1951**, and the proportion of urban population increased to **18.3 percent**. This increases the volume of urban population on account of massive displacement of population at the time of partition of the country during 1947.
- ❖ **Large number of displaced persons from Pakistan had settled in large cities of India**.
- ❖ **Apart from this, generation of employment opportunities in the urban, government and service sectors**. The opening of large number of schools and

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colleges and other educational institutions in cities, increased the volume of security enhanced self-confidence and freedom to live anywhere in India.

- ❖ After **independence had given ample opportunities** to rural Indians to come and settle in the nearby cities.
- ❖ In **the period of 1951-1961 the growth of population bit slow, the exponential growth rate was recorded as 2.34**. Whereas the percentage gain in urban population is only about 0.07, which was less than the gain 0.34 percent during 1941-1951 decade.
- ❖ **This decline is on account of reorganization of state boundaries during 1956**, and also adoption of new definition of classification of rural, urban areas and towns.
- ❖ **As a result of this about 803 smaller towns were merged with other towns or declassified into rural areas**. In spite of such decline in gain in the size of urban population during the decade was on the increasing order as compared to earlier decade.
- ❖ **During decade 1961-1971 and 1971-1981 the movement of growth of urban population had shown increasing order**, growth rate exceeds 3.25 percentages and the size of urban population had increased by 12.5 million on an average per annum.
- ❖ **From 1981 to 2001, census report shows** the rate of growth of urban population was found to be slow, during 1981 to 1991 and 1991 to 2001 the average annual exponential growth rate recorded 3.9 and 2.73 per annum respectively.
- ❖ **But the percentage increase the urban population stood from 17.97 to 27.78 during 1961-2001**. It shows almost uniformity towards increase in urban population.

During the period between 2001 to 2011 the average growth rate of the urban population had increased to 3.38 percent that is about 92 million of urban population added, on account of globalization, attracted more employment opportunities and improvement in both technical and professional education along with more security of life and others.

Growth of Cities (%) in India:

- ❖ **Some of the towns were historically known as marketing and educational service centers**, meeting the needs and necessary service to the surrounding rural settlement in the region.
- ❖ It has been **greatly believed that for a quite a long period of time before the second decade of the 20th century, both the size and number of towns remain the same**.

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- ❖ During this period the size, **growth rate urban population and transfer of individuals from rural to urban area were found to be very slow.**

Table: 2 Trends of urbanization in India census from 1901-2011

Census year	Number of towns/UA	Total population	Urban population	Percentage of Urban population
1901	1827	238396327	25851873	10.84
1911	1815	252093390	25941633	10.29
1921	1949	251321213	28086167	11.18
1931	2072	278977238	33455989	11.99
1941	2250	318660580	44153297	13.86
1951	2843	361088090	62443709	17.29
1961	2365	439234771	78936603	17.97
1971	2590	548159652	109113977	19.91
1981	3378	683329097	159462547	23.34
1991	3768	844324222	217177625	25.72
2001	5161	1027015247	285354954	27.78
2011	7935	1210193422	377105760	31.16

Source: Data computed and compiled from 1901-2011 Census report

- ❖ **Table 2 gives the number of towns in each census periods from 1901 – 2011.** From the table it has been observed that except some *negative increase during 1901-1911*, there have been always positive increases of percentage of urban population in India.
- ❖ During **1921-2011 the number of towns, and total urban population showing an increasing trend.** And also, it has been observed that some fluctuations in number of town 1961 census and after, it is because of some towns were declassified and some new ones were added at each census counts.

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- ❖ Following the changes in the definition of urban areas and city size in 1961 census. 1971 census after, the same 1961 census urban definition was adopted with slight modification of the term “town group” as urban agglomeration by merging several towns.
- ❖ In 2011 census the number of towns UA's increased to 7935 accounted for 31.16 percent urban population.

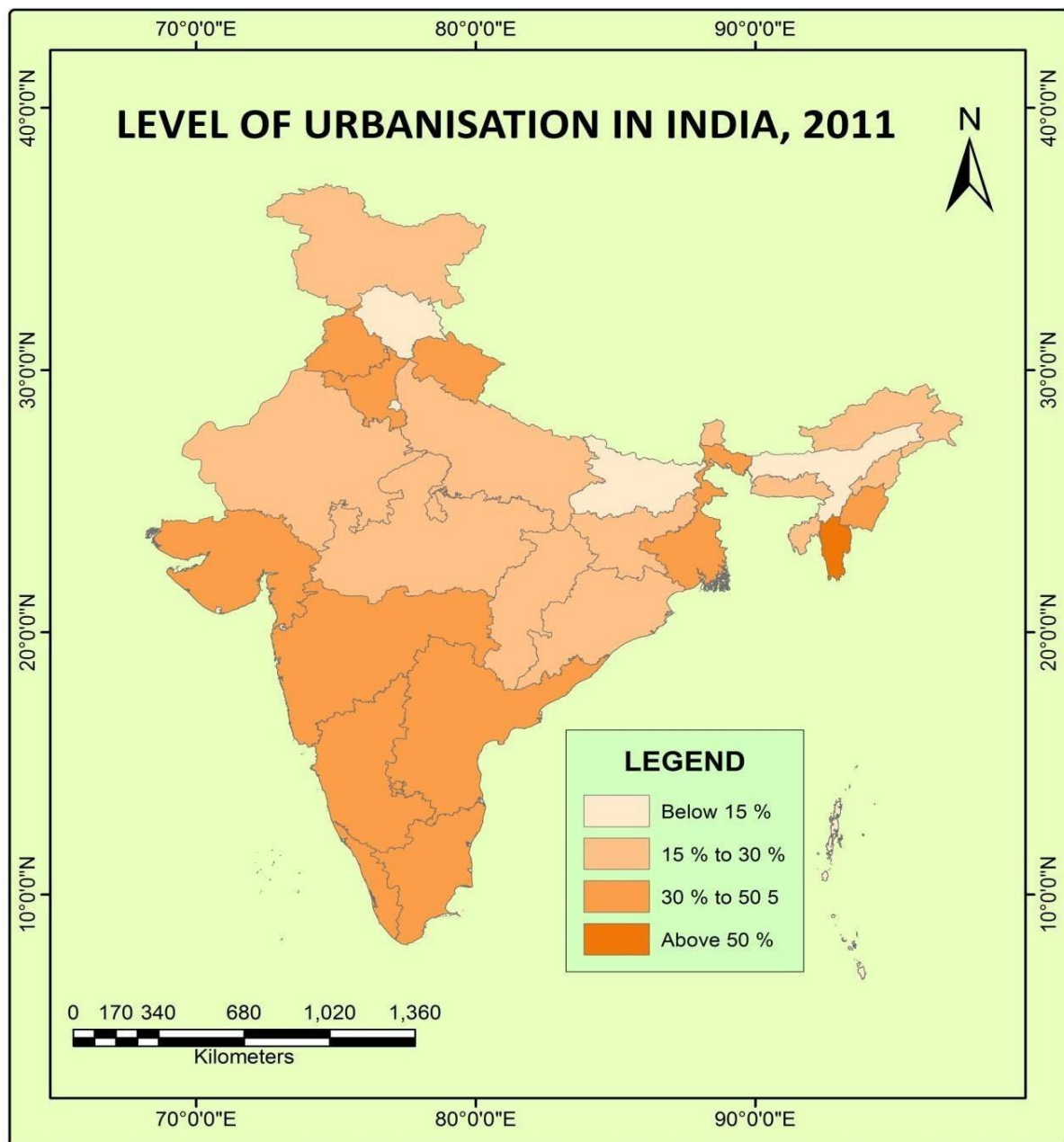


Figure: 3 Levels of Urbanization in India, 2011

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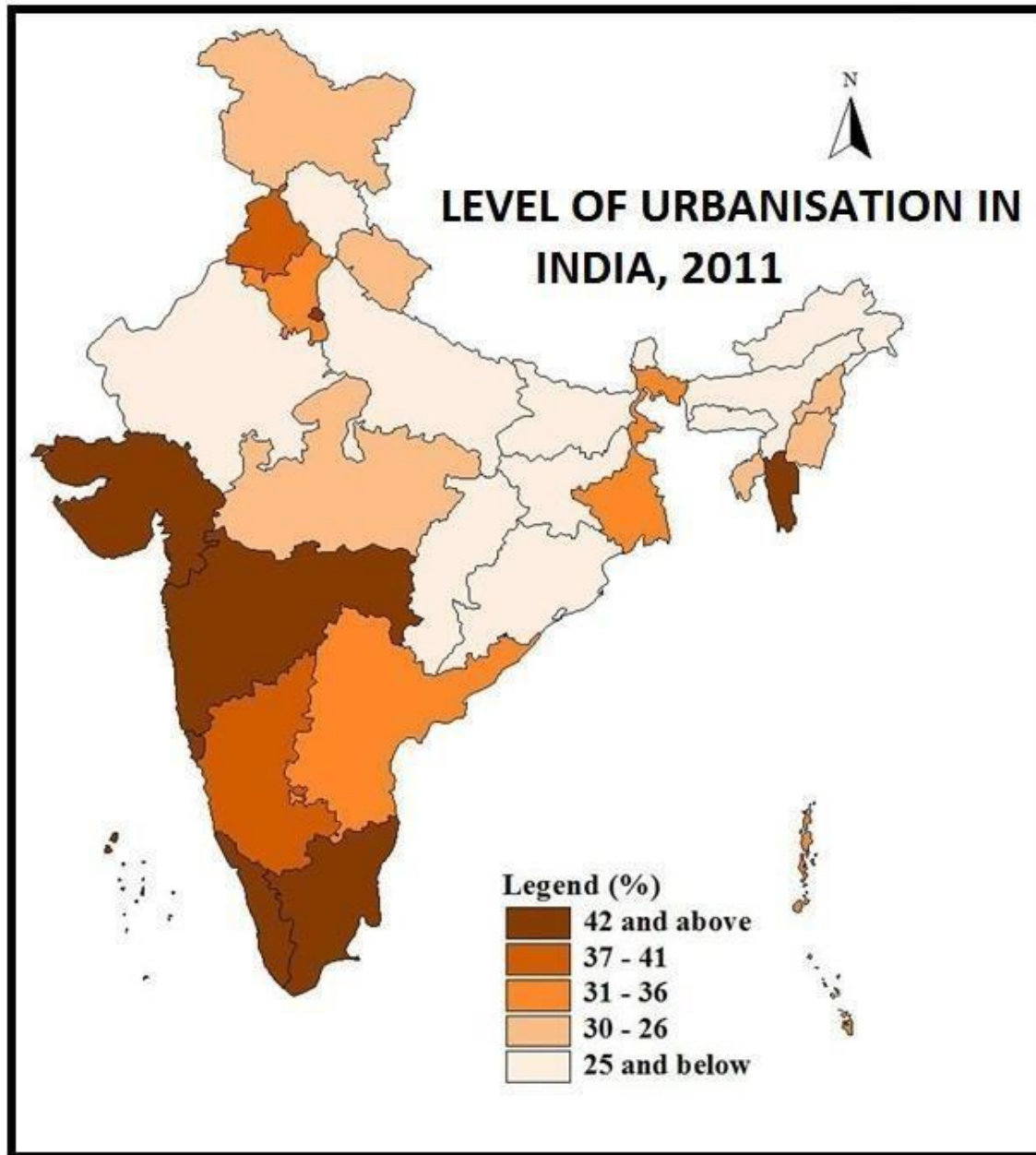


Figure: 4 Levels of Urbanization in India, 2011

Effect of Urbanization in India:

With a high rate of urbanization significant changes have taken place. The effect of urbanization can be summed up as follows: **Positive effect and Negative effect**

- **Positive effects:** Urbanization yields several positive effects if it happens within

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the appropriate limits. Some of the positive implications of urbanization therefore include **creation of employment opportunities, technological and infrastructural advancements, improved transportation and communication, quality educational and medical facilities, and improved standards of living.**

➤ **Negative Effects:**

Extensive urbanization or indiscriminate growth of cities may result in adverse effects. They may be as follows:

- **Slums and associated problems:** The **acute shortage of housing facilities** is one of the **most serious problems** plaguing the Indian cities, whether it is a metropolitan city or a small town.

The reason for this is that the availability and development of housing facility has not expanded fast enough to meet growing demand for rapid urbanization process. **The acute shortage of housing facilities compels the poor to live in slums.** Slums have developed in almost all the Indian cities. Slums are called by the names of Bustees in Calcutta, Jhuggis in Delhi, jhopar-patti in Mumbai and Cheri in Chennai.

The **slums or Bustees have been defined by the government** of India under Slum Area (Improvement and clearance) Act of 1954 **as predominantly a residential area, where dwellings by reason of dilapidation, overcrowding, faulty arrangement and lack of ventilation, light or sanitary facilities or any combination of these factors detrimental to safely, health and morals.**

It is estimated that **40 per cent of people in mega-cities like Calcutta, Mumbai and Delhi live in slums.** Diseases like blood dysentery, diarrhea, malaria, typhoid, jaundice and conjunctivitis, stalk them all the year around. Children with bloated bellies or famished skeletons suffer from polio and common sight.

- **Transport system:** **There are 300 million cars, trucks and buses all over the world.** During peak hours, there will be huge traffic jams in the main junctions. **Because of traffic jams more petroleum products are wasted which results in fuel problem.**
- **Problem of garbage:** **Urban solid waste consists of building materials, plastic containers, hospital wastes, kitchen waste etc.**

A World Bank study revealed that **out of 3,119 towns and cities, only eight had full wastewater collection and treatment facilities,** while another 209

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had partial treatment. A **third of India's population has no access to sanitation services**. It becomes worse in smaller cities and provincial towns.

- **Sewerage problems:** The **urban areas in India are plagued with inefficient and insufficient civic amenities**. The reason for this is that the **unauthorized constructions in and around the city** lie outside the purview of the main systems.

The sewer lines lead to drains, which take the sewage – **93 percent of it untreated – directly into the sea, killing virtually all marine life** along Mumbai's coast. Delhi's Yamuna has turned into a giant sewer, chiefly from raw sewage, 40 per cent of Delhi's sewage is untreated.

- **Water supply:** India has reached a stage where **no city has water supply round the clock**. **Intermittent supply results in a vacuum being created in empty water lines which often suck in pollutions through leaking joints**. Chennai, Hyderabad, Rajkot gets water from municipal sources for less than half an hour every alternative day.

- **Environmental problems:** Environmental pollution is causing concern and affecting human health today than yester decades. **It has been reported by the World Bank that 40,000 persons die in India every year because of air pollution**.

Recent studies also revealed that **a large number of people have been suffering from respiratory diseases, allergies, and cough**. It has been **doubled since 1990s**. Further, it has been noticed that **23 Indian Cities have crossed the dangerous limits because of auto-exhausts and industrial emission**.

- **Degradation of environmental quality:** Due to urbanization, there is **environmental degradation especially in the quality of water, air and noise**. With the **influx of more people in cities, there is great demand of facilities such as housing**. Some unlawful factories and even houses which have a poor infrastructure, the waste from buildings are directly channeled to the nearest river or water resources which directly pollute the water.

Another after effects of rapid urbanization is the air pollution which has also increased due to emanation from motor vehicles, **industrial development and use of non-environmental friendly fuel sources**.

The noise pollution is produced from the various human actions which also degrade the environment and ultimately affect the human health. The growth of population has generated a very high quantity of solid waste and there is pressure to provide a waste disposal place in the urban areas.

- **Decline in quality of living for urban dwellers:** Urbanization is major concern for management researchers because it declines in quality of living for urban

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inhabitants. As the metropolis becomes a developed city, the land value will also increase. **The housing provision will focus more to fulfill the needs of the high-income group.** As such, there will be a problem in the provision of housing, especially for the middle- and low-class people. **The supply of housing for the urban poor is still inadequate as the cost of these houses is very high to which low- and middle-income group cannot afford.** The lack of housing provision for the low-income group has led to the continuation of unlawful resident settlements in the city.

The maintenance of drains and debris collection is incompetent which can raise other serious problems such as **flash floods and poor public health.** The reappearance of flash floods is due to the drainage system being unable to contain surface water run-off that has greatly increased with the higher intensity of urban activities.

- **Unsuccessful urban governance:** The urban authority undergoes with multifaceted challenges to manage a city. **The fast speed of urbanization is major challenges which need every party to be more focused in undertaking each and every responsibility in urban development.** Besides this, the local authority also deals with the different goals and interests of community groups which they need to fulfill. The local authority also needs to find solution for different social issues.
- **Housing:** It is another intense problem due to urbanization in India. **Overcrowding leads to a constant problem of scarcity of houses in urban areas.**
- **Unemployment:** The **situation of employment** is although improving but still remains below desired levels:

In urban male unemployment rose (6.0% to 6.1%), but female unemployment declined (8.9% to 8.2%), keeping the **overall urban rate stable at 6.7%.** At all India level, Unemployment saw a minor drop (5.0% to 4.9%), suggesting slight improvements in employment opportunities **(according to PLFS JAN24-DEC 24, as on April 2025).**

- **Slums and Squatter Settlements:** The natural development of unchecked, unexpected and random growth of urban areas is the growth and spread of slums and unlawful resident settlements.
- **Overcrowding:** Overcrowding means a huge number of people live in a small space. This **form of congestion in urban areas is consistent because of overpopulation and it is an aspect that increases day by day** as more people and immigrants move into cities and towns in search of better life.
- **Poor health and spread of diseases:** The social, economic and living conditions

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in congested urban areas affects access and utilization of public health care services. *Slum areas in particular experience poor sanitation and insufficient water supply which generally make slum populations susceptible to communicable diseases.* The environmental problems such as urban pollution also cause many health problems namely allergies, asthma, infertility, food poisoning, cancer and even premature deaths.

- **Traffic congestion:** When more people move to towns and cities, one of the major challenges posed is in the transport system. **More people means increased number of vehicles which leads to traffic congestion and vehicular pollution.**
- **Urban crime:** *Issues of lack of resources, overcrowding, unemployment, poverty, and lack of social services and education habitually leads to many social problems including violence, drug abuse, and crime. Most of the crimes such as murder, rape, kidnapping, riots, assault, theft, robbery, and hijacking are reported to be more prominent in the urban vicinities.*

Besides, poverty related crimes are the highest in fast-growing urban regions. These acts of urban crime normally upset the peace and tranquility of cities/towns.

Remedial Measures of Urban Problems in India :

- **Building sustainable and environmentally friendly cities:** Governments should pass laws that plan and **provide environmentally sound cities and smart growth techniques, considering that people should not reside in unsafe and polluted areas.**
- **Provision of essential services:** Urban stakeholders must ensure *all populations within the urban areas have access to adequate essential social services namely education, health, sanitation and clean water, technology, electricity, and food.*
- **Creation of more jobs:** To lessen the negative effects of rapid urbanization while at the same time **conserving natural ecosystems, private investments should be encouraged so as to utilize natural resources and create more job opportunities.** Tourism promotion and the sustainable exploitation of natural resources can create more jobs for the urban populations.
- **Population control:** Key stakeholders in urban areas must provide campaigns and counseling for **effective medical health clinics and family planning to help reduce the high rates of population growth.** Medical health clinics oriented towards family planning options must be made accessible across the entire urban area with the objective of controlling diseases and population growth.

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Migration

Human migration is the permanent change of residence by an individual or group from one place to another, either within a country or across international borders. It can be voluntary or forced, and is often driven by economic, social, political, or environmental factors.

Migrant: A person whose last usual place of residence was different from the present place of enumeration on the date of inquiry has been considered as migrants.

Migration Data Methodology as per Census 2011

The Census of India collects migration data through the following questions:

1. **Is the person born in this village or town?** If not, further details are obtained on the rural/urban status of the place of birth, district, state, and, if born outside India, the name of the country.
2. **Has the person migrated to this village or town from elsewhere?** If yes, additional questions are asked about the rural/urban status of the previous place of residence, district, state, and, if from outside India, the name of the country.

In addition to these questions, **information on reasons for migration from the place of last residence and the duration of residence at the enumeration place is also collected.**

Migration in the Census of India is enumerated on two bases:

1. **Place of birth:** For individuals whose place of birth differs from the enumeration place (known as life-time migrants).
2. **Place of residence:** For individuals whose place of last residence differs from the enumeration place (known as migrants by place of last residence).

As of the 2011 Census, out of the total population of 1,211 million people in India, 447 (36.91%) million individuals were reported as migrants by place of birth, while 455 (37.57%) million individuals were reported as migrants by place of last residence.

Causes of Migration: People migrate for many different reasons. These reasons can be classified as economic, social, political or environmental:

- **Economic migration** - moving to find work or follow a particular career path.
- **Social migration** - moving somewhere for a better quality of life or to be closer to family or friends.

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- **Political migration** - moving to escape political persecution or war.
- **Environmental causes** - of migration include natural disasters such as flooding.

Push and Pull factors:

- **Push factors** are the reasons why people leave an area. They include: lack of services • lack of safety • high crime • crop failure • drought • flooding • poverty • war.
- **Pull factors** are the reasons why people move to a particular area. They include:
 - higher employment • more wealth • better services • good climate • safer, less crime • political stability.

RURAL-URBAN MIGRATION:

One of the most significant migration patterns has been **rural to urban migration** the movement of people from the countryside to cities in search of opportunities. This involves the **movement of people from rural areas or countryside to urban areas of the same country in search of new opportunities and lifestyles.**

Causes of Rural-Urban migration

The major causes of rural-urban migration are identified as;

search for better wages, education, political and social stability, better technologies, employment and business opportunities, poverty, unemployment, crop failures and famine, inadequate social amenities and facilities in the rural areas such as pipe borne water, electricity, good roads, hospitals, schools, vocational Centres.

FORMS OF MIGRATION:

The various kinds of migration depend on the flow and number of people often involved, the reasons for their movement, the time they spend in migration, and the nature of that migration. Here are a few forms:

Intercontinental migration

It is when the movement is across continents, such as from Korea (Asia) to Brazil (South America). **If the movement is on the same continent, we say intracontinental migration.**

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Sometimes, **people migrate from one place to the other within the same region, continent or country. This is also known as regional migration or internal migration.**

Forced or involuntary Migration:

This is when the government or **authorities of a place force people to migrate for a reason.**

Impelled Migration: (also called reluctant or imposed migration):

Here, no one is forced to migrate **but due to some push factors such as war, hunger and other difficult conditions**, people decide to leave.

Seasonal Migration:

Sometimes **people move during specific seasons such as crop harvesting and climate to work and then go back** when the season is over

Return Migration/Repatriation:

This involves the **voluntary return of migrants to their original place after they outlive the reasons for which they left.** Often times, young people who move into the cities to work return home when they retire to spend the rest of their lives in the quiet of their towns and with old friends and family.

Immigration: Migrants who **move into a new** place/country are called Immigrants.

Emigration: Migrants who **move out of a place**/country are called Emigrants.